RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

17 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 11:53 PM, Saturday 17 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 40 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 28 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday, 8,730 minutes at 11:00 PM; Dammam halted since 9:42 PM, 73 minutes at the 10:55 PM board check

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INCIDENT SUMMARY

What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday, 8,730 minutes at 11:00 PM; NOTAM A3604/26 keeps it closed until 12:00 AM Sunday 18 Oct, 1 hour away, and GACA has not announced a reopening**.
- No Riyadh takeoff or landing in the last hour; 40 flights cancelled so far for Saturday (32% of scheduled).
- Riyadh airport told passengers at 10:39 to 10:53 PM to follow official authorities and their airline, with no reopening time; SPA extended remote learning in Riyadh and Diriyah to next Thursday.
- No new attack on the Kingdom announced since the four UAV intercepts reported at 5:20 PM.
- Dammam halted since 9:42 PM, 73 minutes at the 10:55 PM board check: no takeoff or landing since Nile Air NP132 to Cairo at 9:42 PM, with several Jeddah flights overdue.

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (8784 min).

40	0/0	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

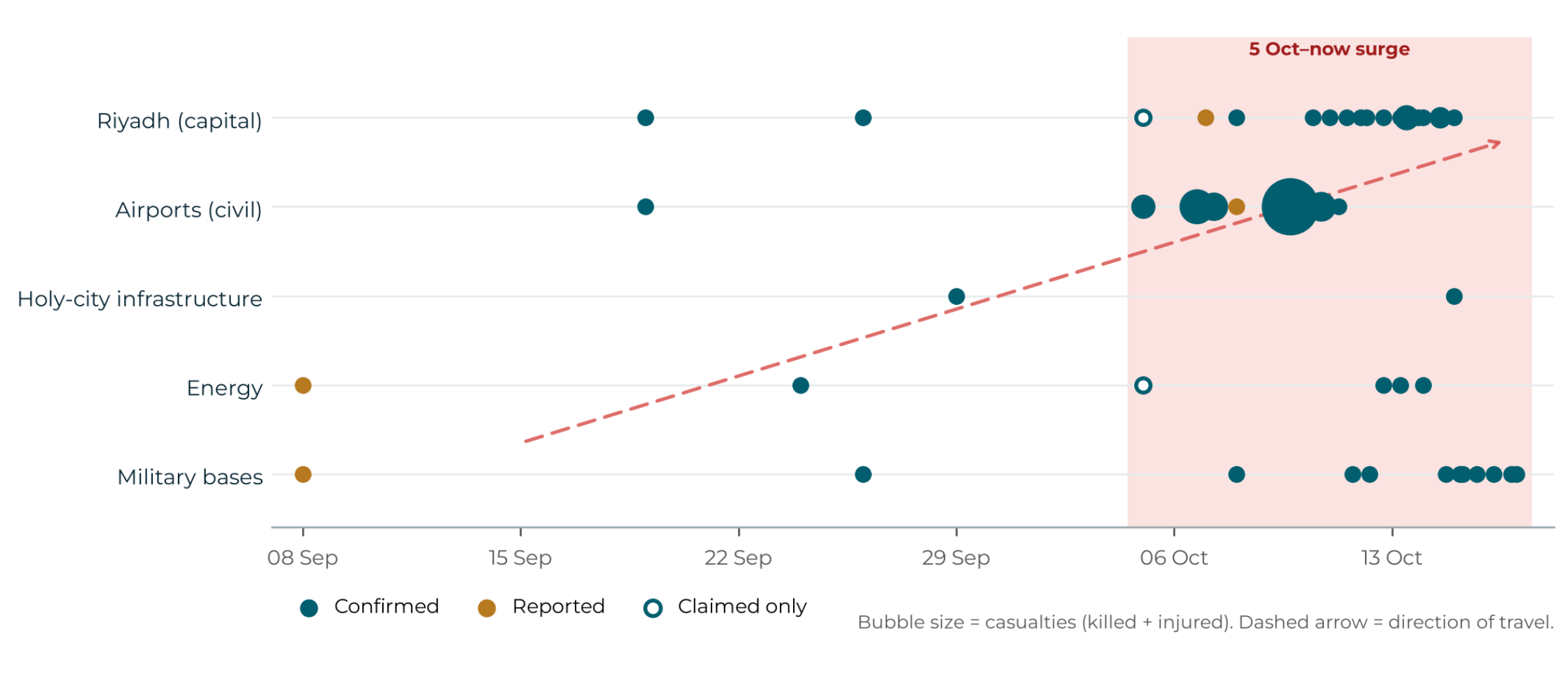
7 takeoffs and 3 landings in the last hour.

28	7/3	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday (8,671 min at 10:00 PM); NOTAM closure runs to 12:00 AM Sunday 18 Oct, 2 hours away
- SPA and Coalition re-posted the intercept footage in English at 9:43 and 9:48 PM; no new attack announced
- Dammam: 3 takeoffs and 5 landings in the last hour, latest NP132 to Cairo at 9:42 PM

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 17 OCT



46 sourced events since 8 September (40 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: four UAVs intercepted and destroyed in past hours across Riyadh, Eastern and Southern regions (17 Oct, Coalition spokesman / SPA / Al Ekhbariya; none reported (intercept)). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

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ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 11:00 PM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

No new attacks, interceptions or alerts since 11:00 PM AST.

Last 24 hours: Attacks 1, interceptions 1, alerts 3, all-clears 3.

3

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday, 2 hours before the NOTAM's planned expiry at midnight; GACA has not announced a reopening

Checked at 11:53 PM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **Coalition spokesman: The Coalition:**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) · **11:41 PM** · published 11:41 PM AST Sat 17 Oct (official account); checked 11:53 PM

The Coalition: Scenes of targeting and destroying two ballistic missile launchers after they were detected being used to launch ballistic missiles towards the Kingdom.

CONFIRMED **SPA: remote learning in Riyadh and Diriyah extended until next Thursday**

SPA (@SPAregions) · **10:48 PM** · published 10:48 PM AST Sat 17 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 10:57 PM

The Saudi Press Agency announced that remote (distance) learning in Riyadh and Diriyah has been extended until next Thursday. The post gives no reason, but it follows a week of missile and drone attacks on the capital.

CONFIRMED **Riyadh airport tells passengers to follow official authorities and their airline; no reopening announced**

King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **10:53 PM** · replies to passengers posted 10:39 to 10:53 PM AST Sat 17 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 10:57 PM

In replies to passengers between 10:39 and 10:53 PM, the airport's official account said that for the latest airspace updates they should follow the competent official authorities and contact the airline they booked with. It added that once operations resume, passengers can ask about luggage at their airline's baggage-services office in the arrivals area. It gave no reopening time.

CONFIRMED **Coalition releases footage of air force intercepting cruise missiles and drones and destroying Houthi ballistic-missile launch platforms**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA (@SPAregions) · **8:51 PM** · published 8:51 PM AST Sat 17 Oct (official account); English version re-posted by the Coalition spokesman at 9:43 PM and SPA at 9:48 PM and 10:28 PM; Al Ekhbariya aired the launcher-strike clip again at 10:07 PM; checked 10:57 PM

The Coalition spokesman posted footage of air force operations intercepting cruise missiles and drones, and of strikes destroying two Houthi ballistic-missile launch platforms that it says had been used to fire missiles toward the Kingdom (per Al Ekhbariya at 10:07 PM). SPA carried the same statement. The posts give no date, place or casualty figures for the operations shown.

CONFIRMED **US Mission: Riyadh airport remains closed; Jeddah and Dammam airports operating with delays and cancellations**

U.S. Mission Saudi Arabia (@USAinKSA) security alert · **7:08 PM** · security alert dated 17 Oct, posted 7:08 PM AST; also relayed by @TravelGov at 7:41 PM; checked 7:52 PM

The U.S. Mission's 17 October security alert says King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh remains closed after recent missile and drone attacks, while Jeddah and Dammam airports are operating with delays and cancellations. It reminds U.S. citizens to follow Saudi Civil Defense cellular-broadcast alerts, and U.S. government staff need special authorization to use any Saudi airport.

CORROBORATED **Trade press: Riyadh closure NOTAM lapses at midnight, but no GACA reopening announcement yet**

AeroCorner · **Sat 17 Oct** · also Gulf Business and Air Data News, 17 Oct; checked 9:57 PM

AeroCorner, Gulf Business and Air Data News report that NOTAM A3604/26 keeps King Khalid International closed until 12:00 AM Sunday 18 Oct, and stress that its expiry is not a reopening date. They found no GACA announcement on resuming flights; several airlines, including Air India, IndiGo and Akasa, have cancelled Saudi flights to 24 Oct.

CONFIRMED **Saudi and Jordanian foreign ministers discuss regional escalation by phone and affirm solidarity**

SPA (@SPAregions) / Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **7:01 PM** · SPA 7:01 PM, Al Ekhbariya 7:08 PM AST Sat 17 Oct (official Saudi channels, translated from Arabic); checked 7:52 PM

SPA reported that Prince Faisal bin Farhan and his Jordanian counterpart discussed recent developments in the region and efforts to contain the conflicts and limit their fallout. They stressed continued coordination and affirmed both countries' solidarity against anything that threatens their security.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: Yemeni armed forces carried out 1,417 strikes on Houthi positions in the past 24 hours under Operation "Dawn of Yemen"**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:59 PM** · published 5:56 PM AST Sat 17 Oct, re-posted 5:59 PM (official Saudi channel, translated from Arabic); figure from the Yemeni side, not independently verified; checked 6:58 PM

Al Ekhbariya reported that, as part of Operation "Dawn of Yemen", Yemeni armed forces carried out 1,417 precise, direct strikes on gatherings of the Houthi militia over the past 24 hours. The figure could not be checked independently.

CONFIRMED **Yemeni PM adviser Ali al-Sarari: government forces expanding control; Houthi militia beginning to collapse**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:39 PM** · published 5:39 PM AST Sat 17 Oct (official Saudi channel, translated from Arabic); claim from Yemeni government side, not independently verified; checked 5:52 PM

Al Ekhbariya quoted Yemeni Prime Minister's adviser Ali al-Sarari saying government forces are expanding and retaking control of some areas and that the Houthi militia has begun to collapse. The claim could not be checked independently.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: four UAVs intercepted and destroyed in past hours across Riyadh, Eastern and Southern regions**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA English (@Spa_Eng) / SPA (@SPAregions) / Al Ekhbariya · **5:33 PM** · Coalition spokesman posted 5:20 PM AST Sat 17 Oct; SPA regions 5:22 PM; Al Ekhbariya 5:23 PM; SPA English 5:33 PM; Al Ekhbariya re-posted it at 6:11 PM; no casualty or impact claimed; checked 6:58 PM

The Coalition spokesman said four UAVs were intercepted and destroyed in the past hours across the Riyadh, Eastern and Southern regions. SPA English, SPA regions and Al Ekhbariya carried the same statement. No casualties or ground impact were reported.

UNVERIFIED **Gulf News: Emirates cancels Dubai flights to Riyadh, Jeddah and Dammam for Saturday and Sunday; Abu Dhabi to Riyadh off through Sunday**

Gulf News · **Sat 17 Oct** · Saturday 17 Oct update, publication time not shown; airline statements not checked directly; checked 4:52 PM

Gulf News reports that Emirates has cancelled flights between Dubai and Dammam, Jeddah and Riyadh for Saturday 17 and Sunday 18 October, and that all Abu Dhabi to Riyadh flights are cancelled through Sunday. It says Dammam's King Fahd International is operating with some services affected.

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KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (8784 min).

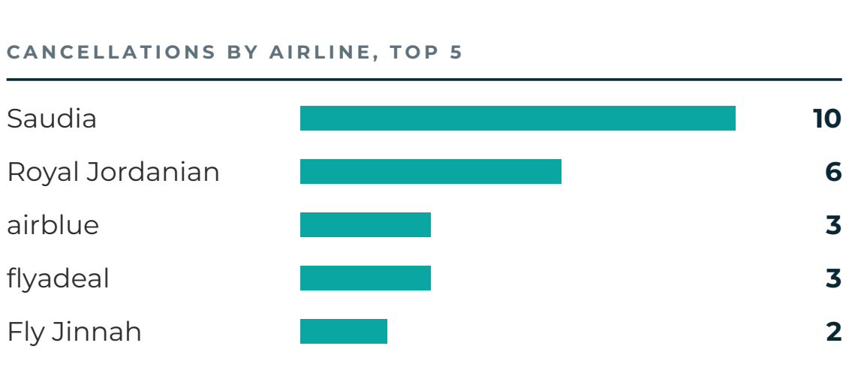
40	—	—	0	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
18 departures + 22 arrivals, 32% of 126 scheduled.	None on the board.	None on the board.	0 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 11:53 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 40 at 11:54 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

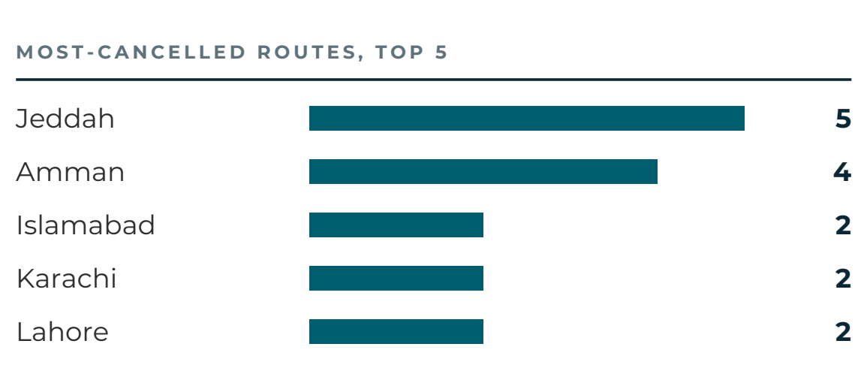
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	**18**	**22**	**40**	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	**18 (32%)**	**22 (31%)**	**40**	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	**1 (2%)**	**0 (0%)**	**1**	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	**4 (80%)**	**18 (100%)**	**22**	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	**0 min**	**0 min**	**—**	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	**0 of 55**	**0 of 70**	**0 of 125**	FR24 boards
Diverted today	**—**	**0**	**0**	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	**175**	**159**	**334**	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	**98**	**87**	**185**	FR24 stats panel

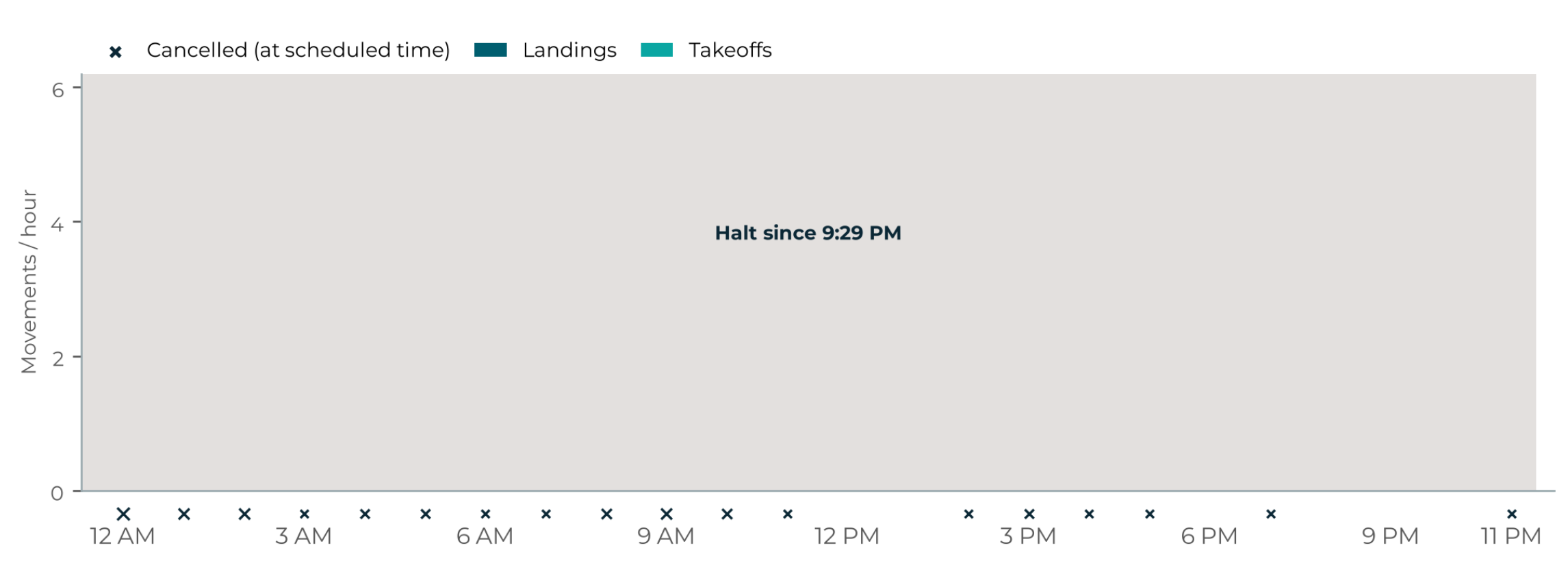
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



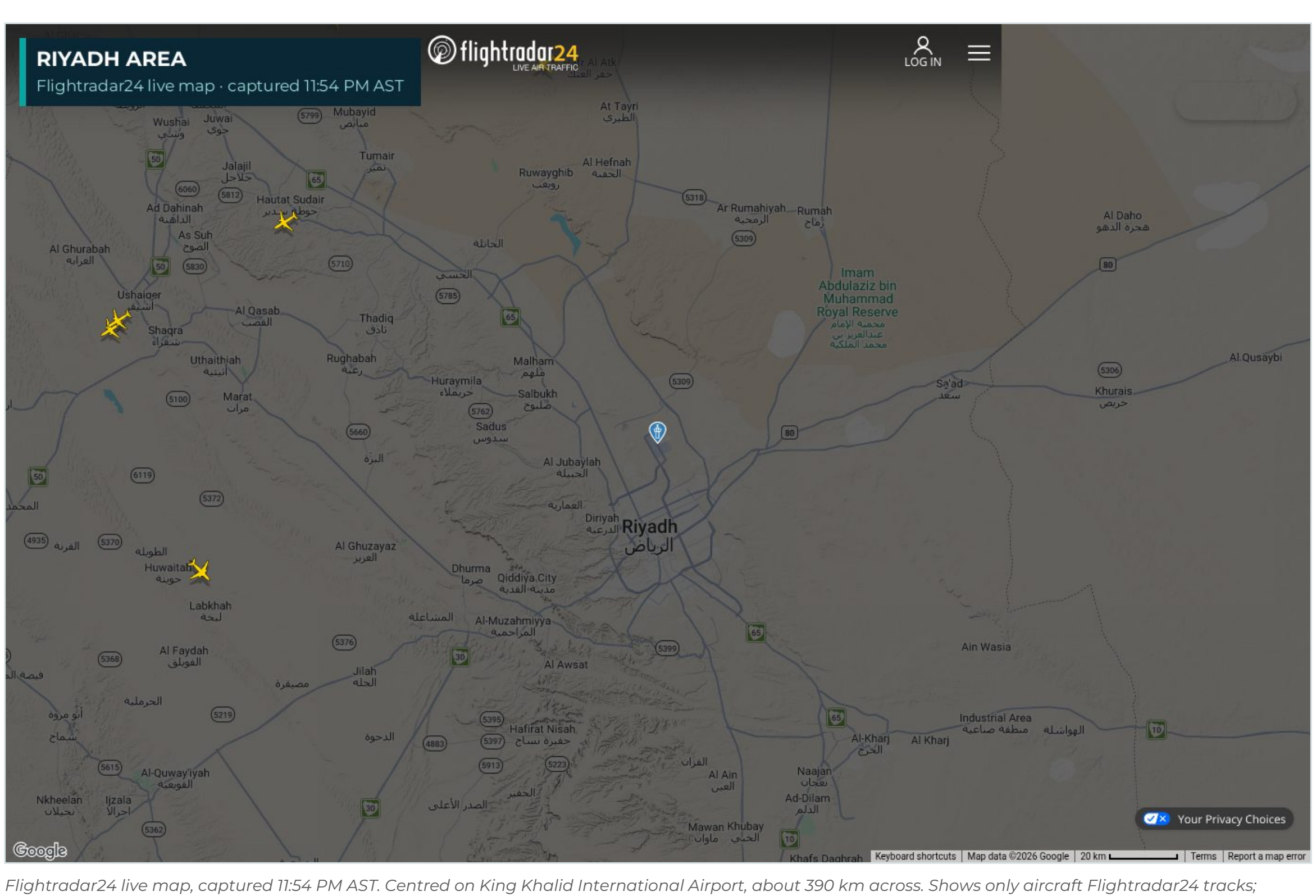
Recorded takeoffs (0) and landings (0) at RUH per hour from 12:00 AM Saturday to 11:53 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday covers the whole window, with no Riyadh movement in it. Dammam's halts in the window ran 11:32 PM–12:18 AM, 12:27–1:40 AM, 1:50–2:41 AM, 3:06–4:21 AM, 4:31–5:27 AM, 5:27–7:17 AM and 5:09–6:01 PM; Dammam has been moving since 6:01 PM with no halt open; its latest movement was Nile Air NP132 taking off for Cairo at 9:42 PM.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	8784 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 11:54 PM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

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KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

Dammam airport: disrupted. 7 takeoffs and 3 landings in the last hour.

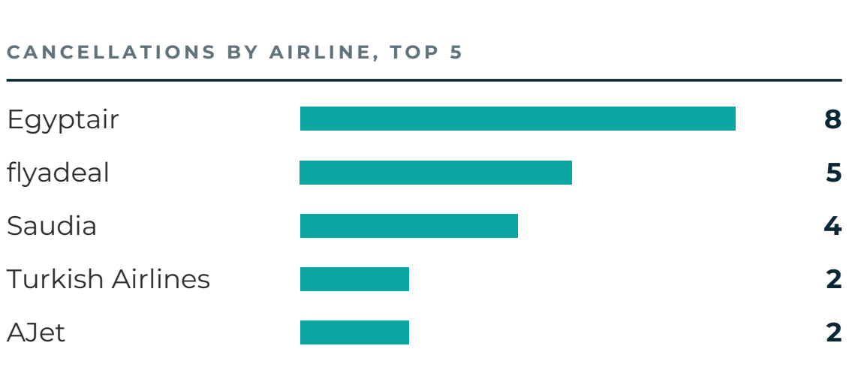
28	11:35 PM	11:39 PM	7	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
14 departures + 14 arrivals, 15% of 192 scheduled.	XY703 to Madinah, 19 min before 11:53 PM.	F31072 from Bisha, 14 min before 11:53 PM.	3 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 11:53 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 28 at 11:54 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

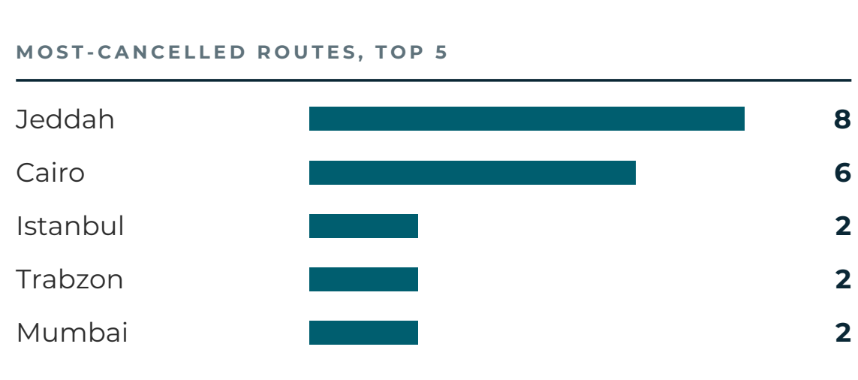
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	**14**	**14**	**28**	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	**14 (15%)**	**14 (14%)**	**28**	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	**32 (33%)**	**24 (24%)**	**56**	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	**30 (48%)**	**40 (62%)**	**70**	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	**16 min**	**5 min**	**—**	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	**60 of 95**	**59 of 95**	**119 of 190**	FR24 boards
Diverted today	**—**	**0**	**0**	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	**21**	**20**	**41**	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	**31**	**37**	**68**	FR24 stats panel

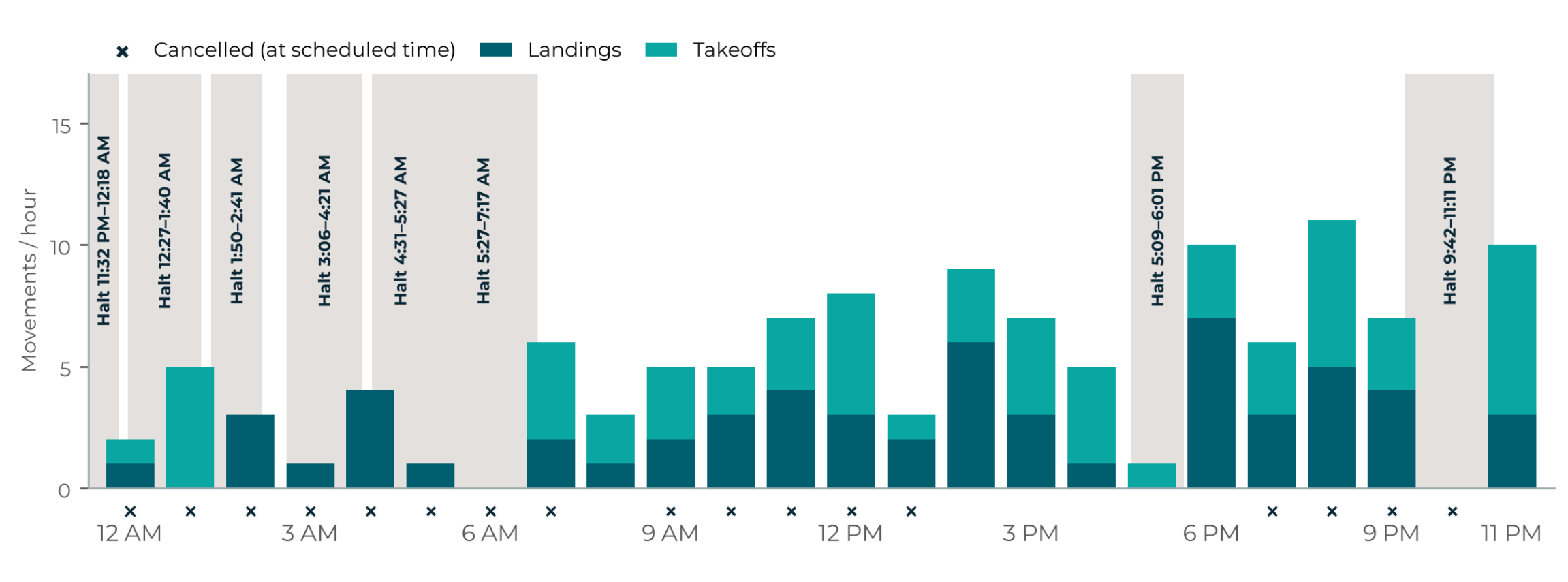
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (60) and landings (59) at DMM per hour from 12:00 AM Saturday to 11:53 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Halt open since 9:42 PM (73 min at 10:55 PM). 0 takeoffs and 0 landings in the last hour.

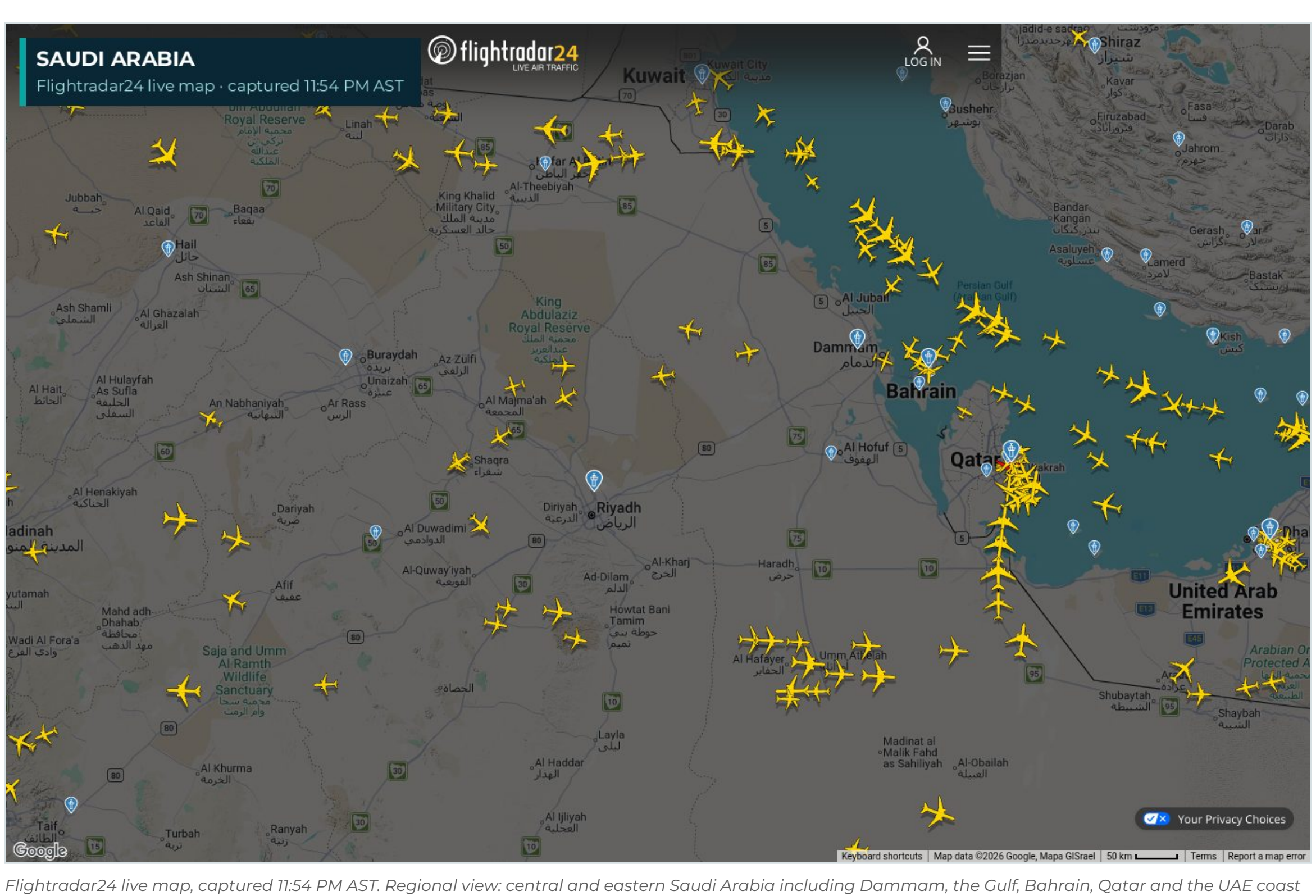
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 9:42–11:11 PM	89 min
Halt 5:09–6:01 PM	53 min
Halt 5:27–7:17 AM	109 min
Halt 4:31–5:27 AM	56 min
Halt 3:06–4:21 AM	76 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

No Dammam airport-specific statement or credible report found in this edition's news check (11:53 PM).

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 11:54 PM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

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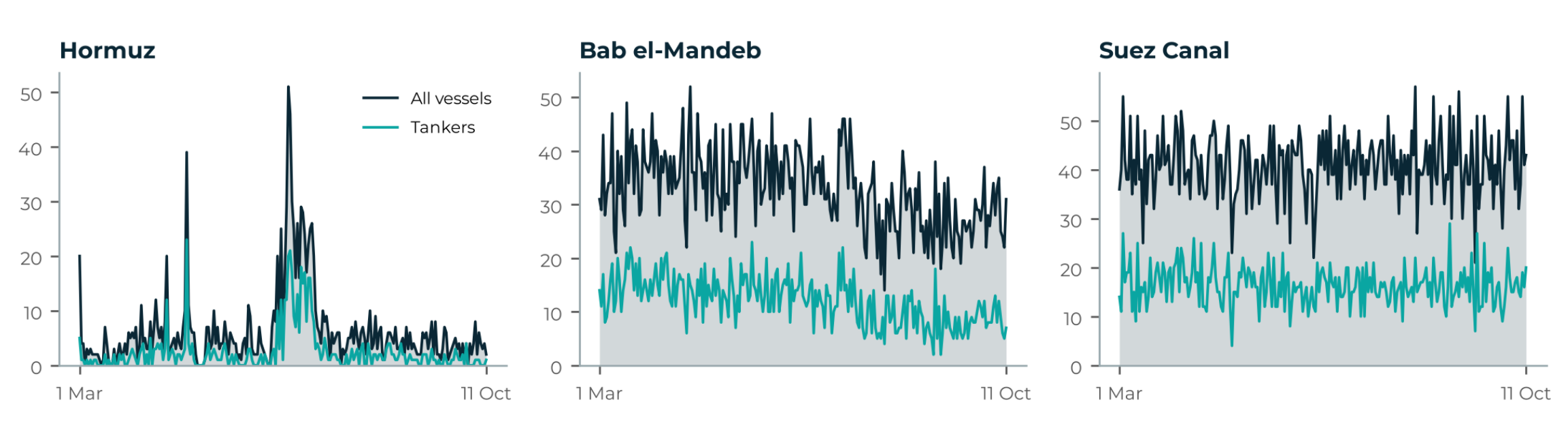
ECONOMY

Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

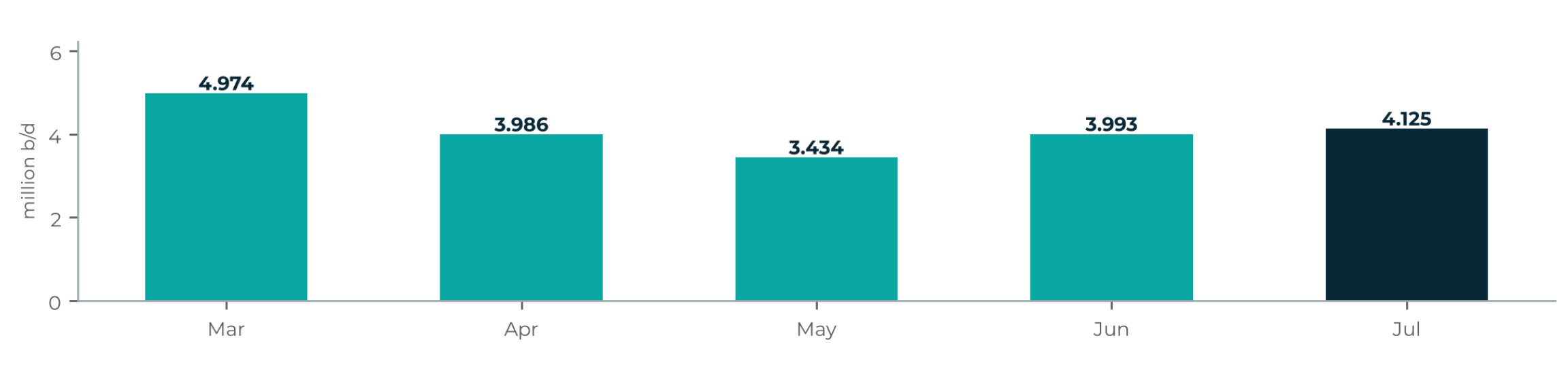
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 11 Oct	**2**	1	1	4.1 (2.7)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 11 Oct	**31**	7	24	28.3 (29.6)
Suez Canal	Sun 11 Oct	**43**	20	23	41.7 (43.1)



*Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. **Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.** Fetched 11:55 PM, Sat 17 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

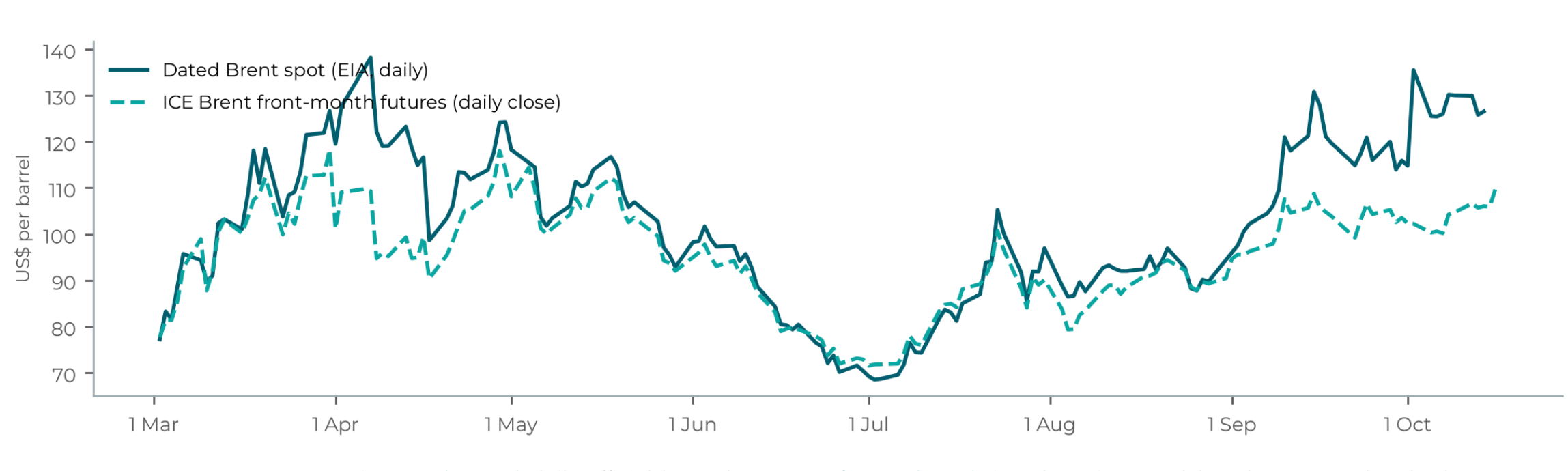


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$109.86	$126.55	+4%	+64%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 11:59 PM, Fri 16 Oct AST (+3.7% on day). Near real time.	Wed 14 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $121.25 on Mon 14 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

7

METHOD AND LIMITS

What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 11:53 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
11:53 PM, Sat 17 Oct	11:53 PM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted**	Open sources · not official	12:00 AM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 12:00 AM